

Robert Shields

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PROFILE

Pragmatic Software Engineer (3 years in Software Development). I enjoy untangling messy systems and leaving them simpler than I found them. Day to day that means Go, Redis and a lot of conversations with the people who use what we build.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Bachelor, Biology

Lake Ryanchester University | 2017–2021

2:1 Honours

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ironwood Consulting — Software Engineer

2024–2026 | Wongborough (Remote (UK))

- Cut CI build times by 60% by parallelising the Prometheus pipeline and caching dependency layers.
- Hardened authentication flows in Go after a security review, closing 3 findings before audit.
- Led the migration of a legacy monolith to Go, taking deployments from fortnightly to 50 per day.
- Replaced a third-party dependency with an in-house Go module, saving \$10k per year in licence fees.

Junior Mobile Engineer, Nova Tech Group

2022–2024 | North Kenneth

- Drove the team's adoption of trunk-based development, reducing merge conflicts and lead time by 25%.
- Refactored the billing module behind a feature flag, eliminating 70% of recurring production incidents.
- Introduced contract testing with the automation framework, lifting coverage from 40% to 96% and cutting integration bugs.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Skill	Experience
Go	2 yrs
Redis	2 yrs
JavaScript	2 yrs
Git	2 yrs
SQL	1 year
Prometheus	2 yrs

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Git utility library

Open-source helper library for Git, ~500 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) — ISC2, 2019

ISTQB Certified Tester - Foundation Level — ISTQB, 2022

Professional Data Engineer — Google Cloud, 2019

PUBLICATIONS

"Sequence alignment heuristics for large genomes" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2021.

"Population modelling under habitat fragmentation" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2023.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

STEM ambassador running school workshops twice a term.

LANGUAGES

English – Native

INTERESTS

Open-source contribution, Chess, Woodworking

References available upon request.